

Copilot in Excel questions and answers

Intro to Copilot in Excel | Updated September 25, 2026

What can I use it for?

Ask for help with formulas, formatting, summaries and charts. Start with a specific task, inspect the workbook, and ask for a refinement.

Why does my screen look different?

Your account, subscription, app version and organization settings affect access. Check the controls available in your own Excel session. Ask your Microsoft 365 administrator about organization-specific licensing and settings.

What are the modes?

Chat only answers in the conversation. Plan outlines an approach. Allow editing changes the workbook. Older tutorials may call the editing experience Agent Mode.

Must my file be in the cloud with AutoSave on?

Supported desktop versions can work with locally saved modern Excel workbooks. AutoSave can be on or off. Internet access is still required. Use a working copy while experimenting.

Do I still need to understand Excel?

You should understand the task and check the result. Inspect formulas, totals, dates and units. Excel tables are a helpful way to organize data and make formulas easier to follow.

Why did I get a different result?

AI output can vary. Different layouts can be valid if the calculations and meaning agree. Copilot can also make mistakes, so compare results with the source data.

Will my report update?

Inspect what Copilot created. Formulas can recalculate, PivotTables may need Refresh, and a static image or pasted answer does not become a live chart merely because it is in Excel.

What happened to the COPILOT worksheet function?

Microsoft states that the preview =COPILOT function became unavailable starting September 14, 2026. Use the Copilot pane for AI requests. Ordinary Excel functions remain part of the webinar.

Microsoft references

[Access and licensing](#)

[Prompting and AutoSave](#)

[Locally saved workbooks](#)

[COPILOT function retirement update](#)